



# Kanban

## User Manual

App version 0.1.15 · July 2026

Welcome! This guide covers everything you can do in Sabeel Kanban — from finding your first board to running boards and approving accounts. It is organized by role: **everyone** starts with Part 1; **managers** add Part 2; **admins** add Part 3. Part 4 is a quick “How do I...?” index you can skim any time.

The app works the same on the website (<https://sabeel-institute-kanban.web.app>) and the Android app — same account, same data, live everywhere. It is **phone-first**: the mobile layout is its own thing, not a squeezed desktop board. Throughout this guide, where the phone and browser layouts differ, you’ll see them side by side.

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## The big picture (2 minutes)

1. **Work lives on boards.** A board is a set of **columns** (like *To Do* → *In Progress* → *Done*) holding **cards**. Each card is one piece of work.
2. **You see the boards you’ve been added to.** Managers can see and join every board and create new ones; members see only theirs.
3. **A card carries everything about a task** — a description, a priority, a due date, the people assigned, labels, and a comment thread. Open it to see or change any of that in one place.
4. **Everything is live and shared.** Move a card and everyone watching sees it move. **My Work** gathers every card assigned to you, across every board, so you never have to go board-hunting to find what’s yours.

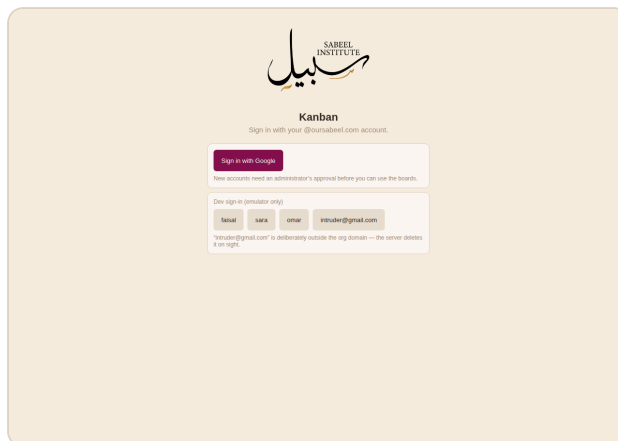
That’s the whole system. Everything below is detail.

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# Part 1 — For everyone

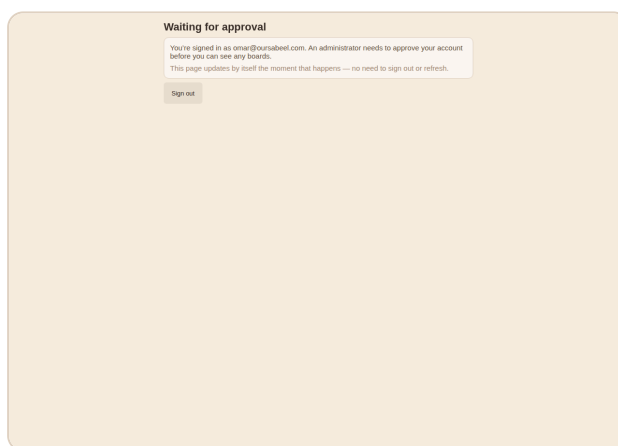
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## 1.1 Signing in



Open the app or website and tap **Sign in with Google**. Sign-in is restricted to your **@oursabeel.com** account — no other account works, and there is no password to remember.

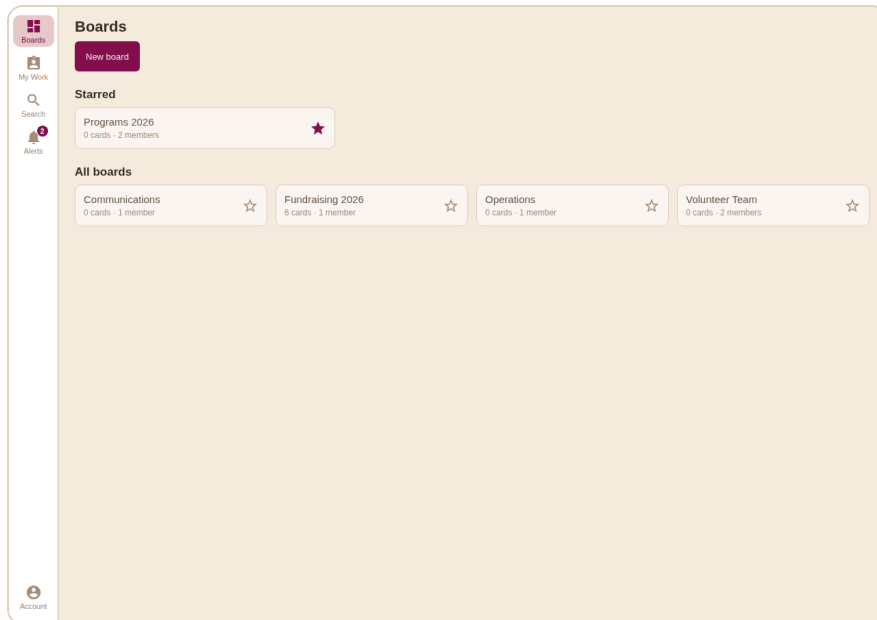
### First time? You'll wait for approval



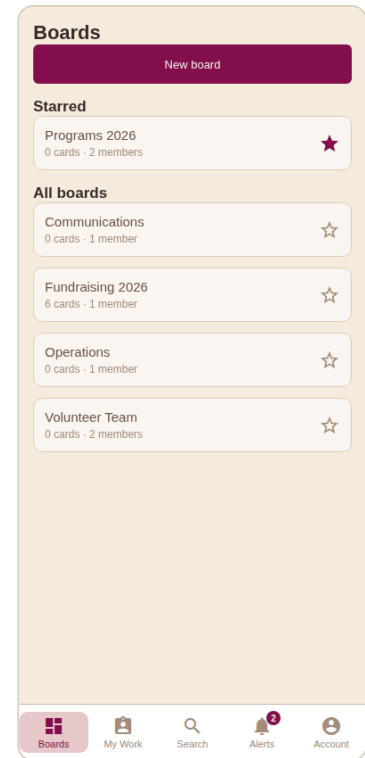
New accounts land on a **“Waiting for approval”** screen. An administrator has to approve your account before you can see any boards — this is deliberate, and it takes them one tap. Leave the page open: it lets you in by itself the moment they approve you, with no need to sign out or refresh. If you seem stuck here, contact your admin.

## 1.2 Finding your way around

A slim navigation bar is always in reach — **along the bottom on a phone**, and **down the left side in a browser**. It carries the places you move between:



*In a browser — a rail down the left*



*On a phone — a bar along the bottom*

- **Boards** — your board list, the home screen.
- **My Work** — every card assigned to you, across every board.
- **Search** — find a card by its words.
- **Alerts** — what you’ve been told about; a badge shows how many are unread.
- **Account** — People (admins only) and Sign out.

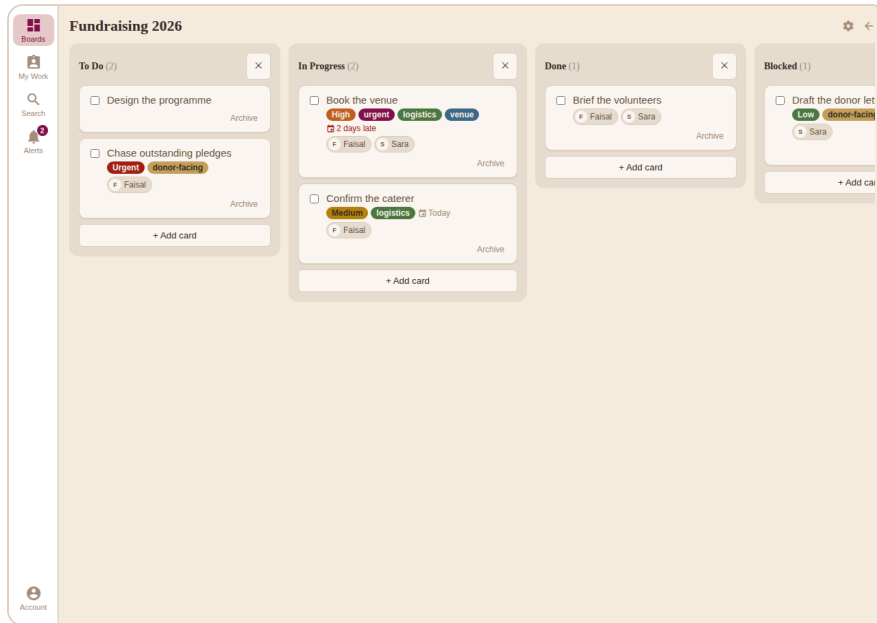
Open a board or a card and the phone’s bottom bar steps aside, giving the board the whole screen; it returns when you go back to a list. In a browser the left rail stays put — it’s narrow enough to keep out of the way.

## 1.3 Your boards

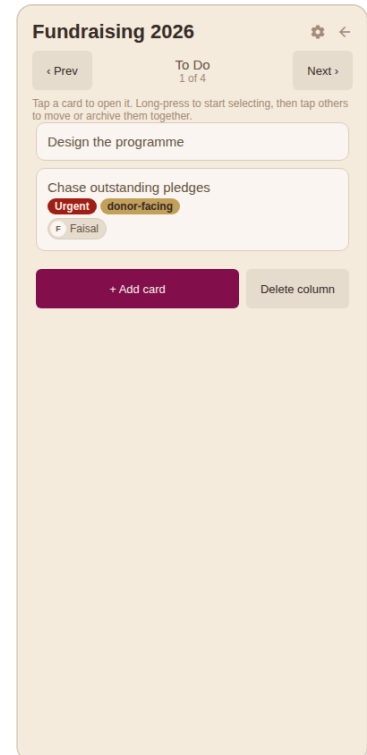
**Boards** lists everything you can open. Tap the **star** beside a board to keep it at the top; boards you’ve opened recently follow, then the rest alphabetically.

Every board shows as a card in a grid on wide screens, and as a single-column list on a phone. Managers create boards with **New board** (see Part 2).

## 1.4 Inside a board



*In a browser — every column at once*



*On a phone — one column, swipe between*

A board is columns of cards. **In a browser** you see every column at once. **On a phone** one column fills the screen — swipe left and right to move between them, and the header tells you where you are (“In Progress, 2 of 4”).

Each card shows, at a glance: its **title**, a **priority badge**, its **labels**, its **due date** (red if overdue), and the **people assigned** (as name chips) — so you can read a card without opening it. A card with no priority set shows no badge. Tap **+ Add card** at the bottom of a column, type a title, press Enter — that’s a new card.

## 1.5 Working with a card

Tap any card to open the full view.

In a browser

On a phone

- **Title** — tap to edit; a **Save** button appears only once you've changed it.
- **Column** — a dropdown showing where the card sits. Change it to move the card without leaving it.
- **Description** — plain text. Type whatever you like; it appears to everyone exactly as you typed it. **Save** to keep it, **Cancel** to discard.
- **Subtasks** — see below.
- **Priority** — none / low / medium / high / urgent, shown as a coloured **badge** on the card face (e.g. *Urgent*); *none* shows no badge.
- **Due date** — a whole day, not a time. Pick it from a calendar; **Clear** removes it. An overdue card shows in red and says *Overdue*.
- **Assignees** — anyone on the board. They show as **name chips** on the card face, the card lands in each person's **My Work**, and they're notified.
- **Labels** — a short, shared vocabulary defined per board, shown as coloured **badges** on the card face.
- **Comments** — discuss the work. Type **@** followed by a name to pull someone in; they're notified.
- **Activity** — who changed what, and when. Written by the system, so no one can edit it.

Ordinary actions — move, archive, assign, delete — are **icons**, not big buttons, so a card stays compact. Each icon has a label for screen readers.

## Subtasks — breaking a card down

A card can be broken into **subtasks**, which are simply other cards on the same board, linked to it.

- Type a title under **Subtasks** and tap **+** to create one. It's made in the same column as the card you're on.
- **Link an existing card** attaches a card that's already on the board. There's a filter box, because a board can hold a lot of cards.
- Tap any subtask to **jump straight to it**; it opens like any other card, with its own column, assignees, due date and comments. The subtask shows **Subtask of** at the top — tap that to come back up.
- The unlink icon separates the two cards again. **It does not delete anything** — the subtask stays on the board as an ordinary card.
- A parent card shows a small **N subtasks** marker on the board, so you can tell at a glance that it breaks down further.

A subtask is a real card, not a checklist item: it moves through columns, gets assigned, and can be discussed like anything else. A card can be a subtask of only one other card, and both must be on the same board.

## Sharing a card

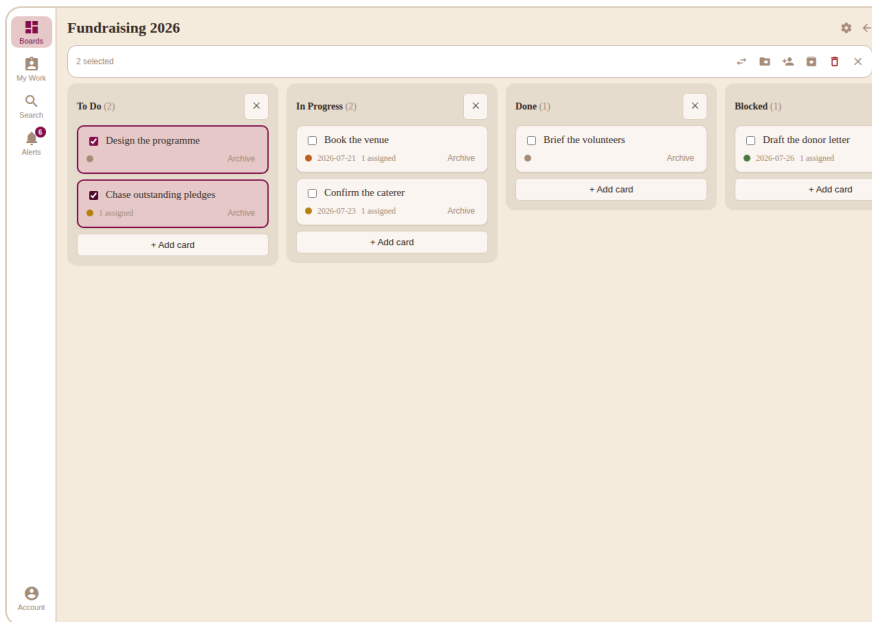
The top of every card shows **which board it's on** — tap it to jump straight to that board. Beside the back arrow is a **Share** button. It hands the card's link to your phone's share sheet — WhatsApp, Google Chat, a text, whatever you use — or, on a computer, copies the link to paste anywhere.

Whoever opens the link lands directly on that card, as long as they're signed in and a member of its board. If they aren't a member, or the card has been deleted, the link says so instead of opening a blank screen.

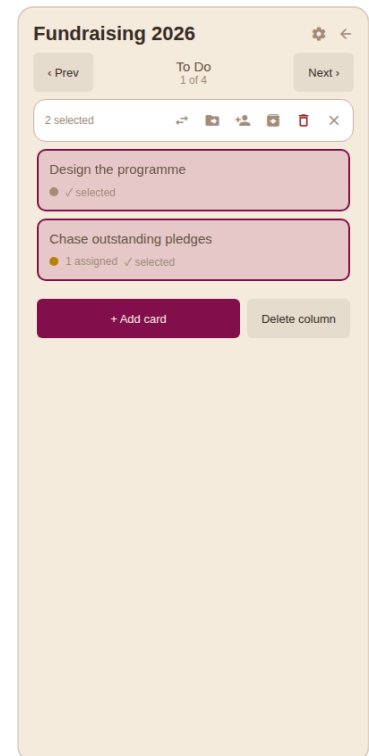
## Moving cards

**In a browser**, drag a card between columns. **On a phone**, long-press the card and pick the destination column — dragging isn't used on a screen that already swipes between columns, where a drag would be ambiguous.

### 1.6 Doing several cards at once



*In a browser — tick the boxes*



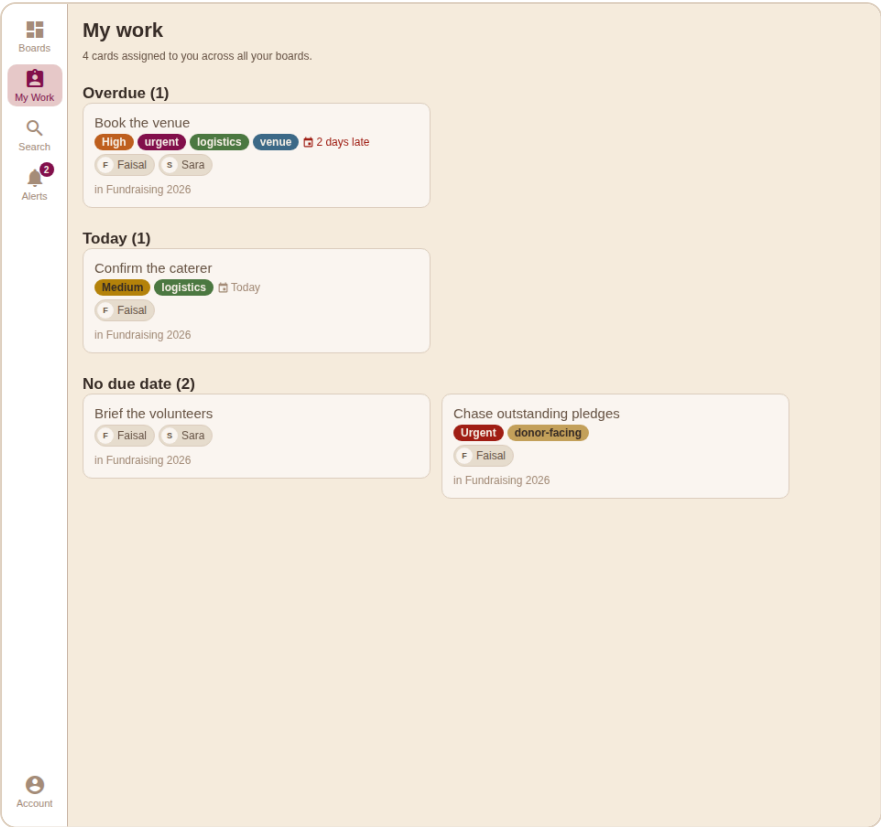
*On a phone — long-press, then tap*

Select several cards — **tick the boxes** in a browser (hold **Shift** for a range), or **long-press** one on a phone and then tap the rest. A bar appears with what you can do to the whole selection: **move**, **assign**, **archive**, or (managers) **delete**.

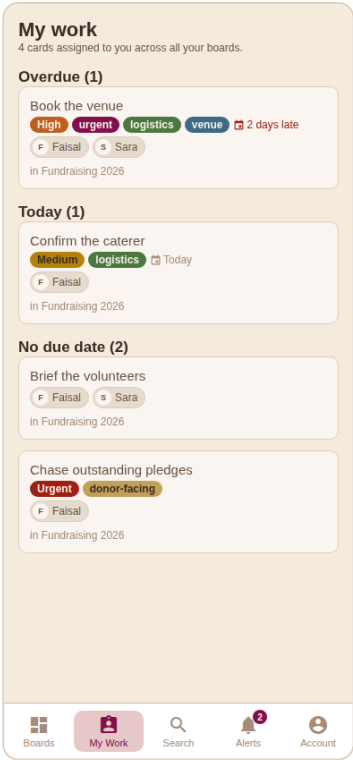
You can also **copy or move the selection to another board** — pick one of your boards, then a column in it. A **move** takes the cards over as they are (comments and history included); a **copy** leaves the originals in place and starts fresh cards with no comments. Either way the cards' **labels are cleared** (labels belong to a board), and anyone **not a member of the destination board is unassigned** — the sheet tells you before you confirm.



# 1.7 My Work



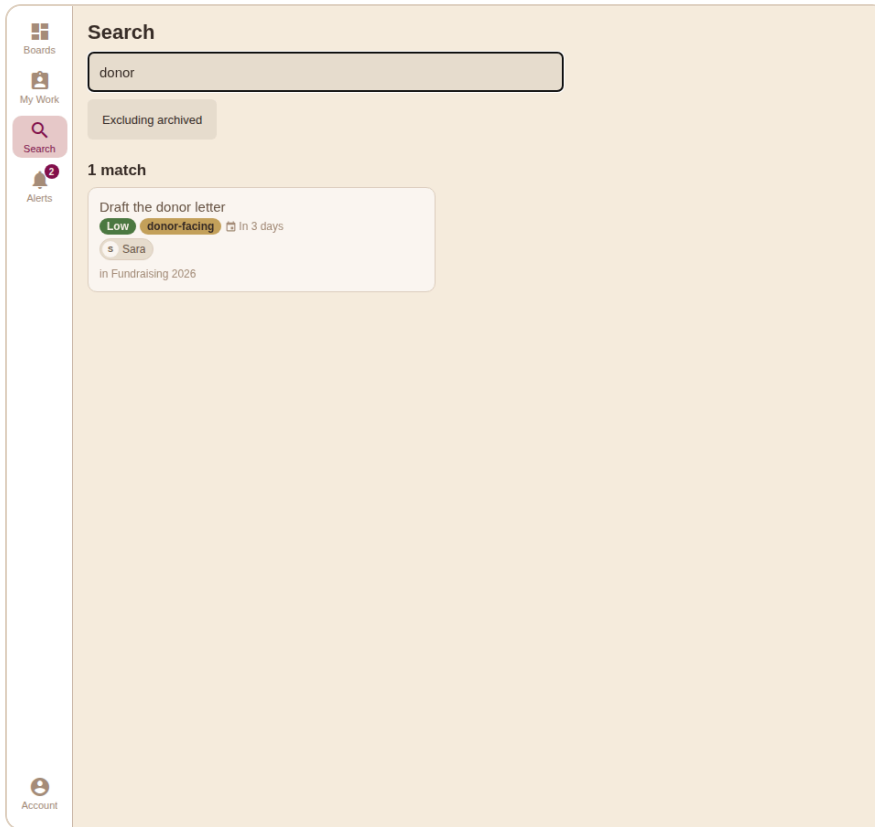
In a browser



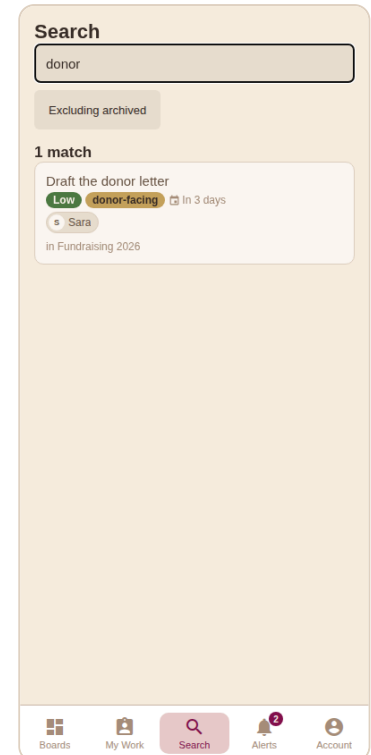
On a phone

Everything assigned to you, across every board, grouped by urgency: **overdue** first, then **today**, then the **next seven days**, then everything else. This is the fastest way to see what needs you — especially on a phone. Tap any card to open it.

## 1.8 Search



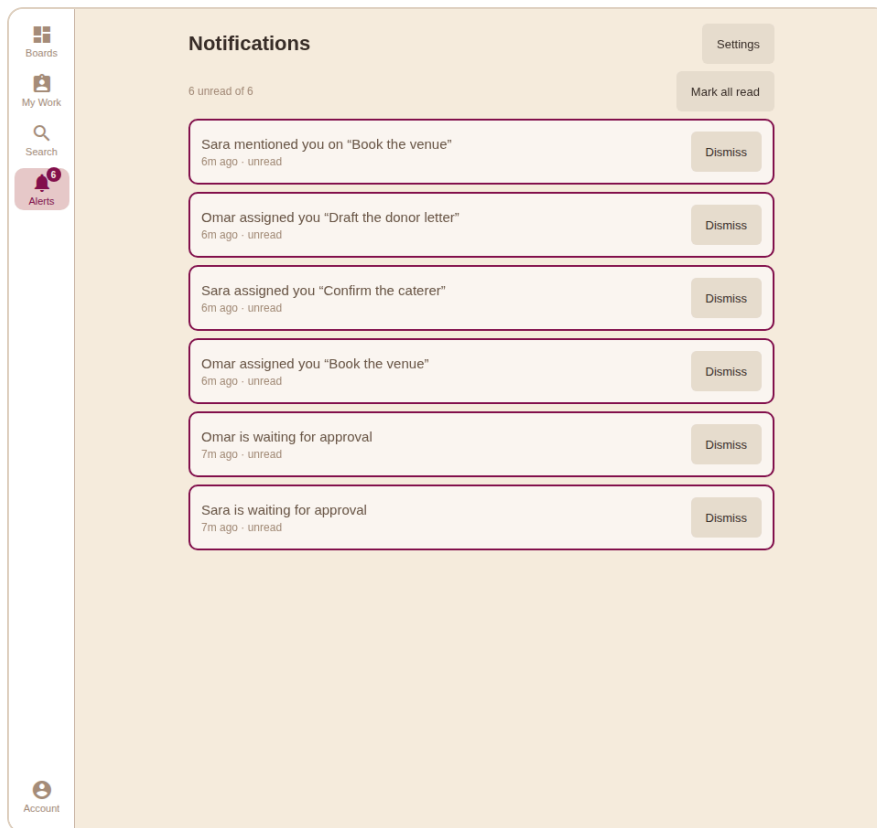
*In a browser*



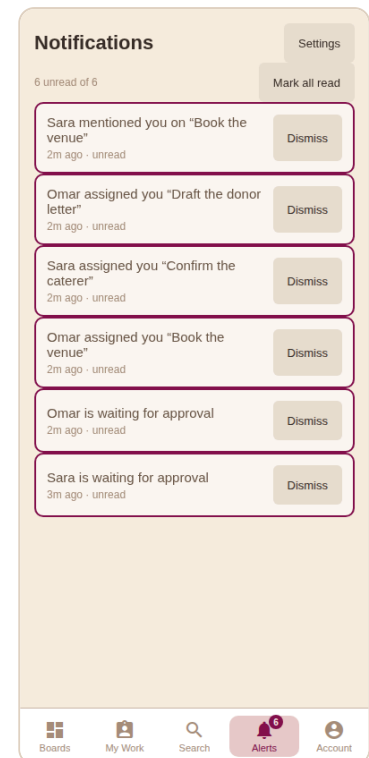
*On a phone*

Searches card titles and descriptions across every board you belong to. It matches whole words and parts of words, but not misspellings. Archived cards are left out unless you ask for them. Tap a result to open the card.

## 1.9 Notifications



*In a browser*



*On a phone*

**Alerts** shows everything you've been told about, so nothing is lost if a phone notification is missed or swiped away. You're alerted when a card is **assigned** to you, when someone **@mentions** you in a comment, and — for admins — when a **new account** is waiting. Unread items are outlined; tap one to jump straight to the card.

Under **Settings** there you can turn each kind of notification on or off, and **mute** individual boards. One kind is off by default — “a card assigned to you was moved” — because on a busy board it fires constantly. **You are never notified about your own actions.**

The app asks for notification permission when you sign in — allow it on each device where you want push notifications. Notifications follow the account signed in on the device.

## 1.10 Signing out

**Account** → **Sign out** (in the navigation bar). Signing out clears your session on this phone or browser and stops it receiving that account's notifications. The next sign-in shows Google's account chooser, which is how you switch accounts.

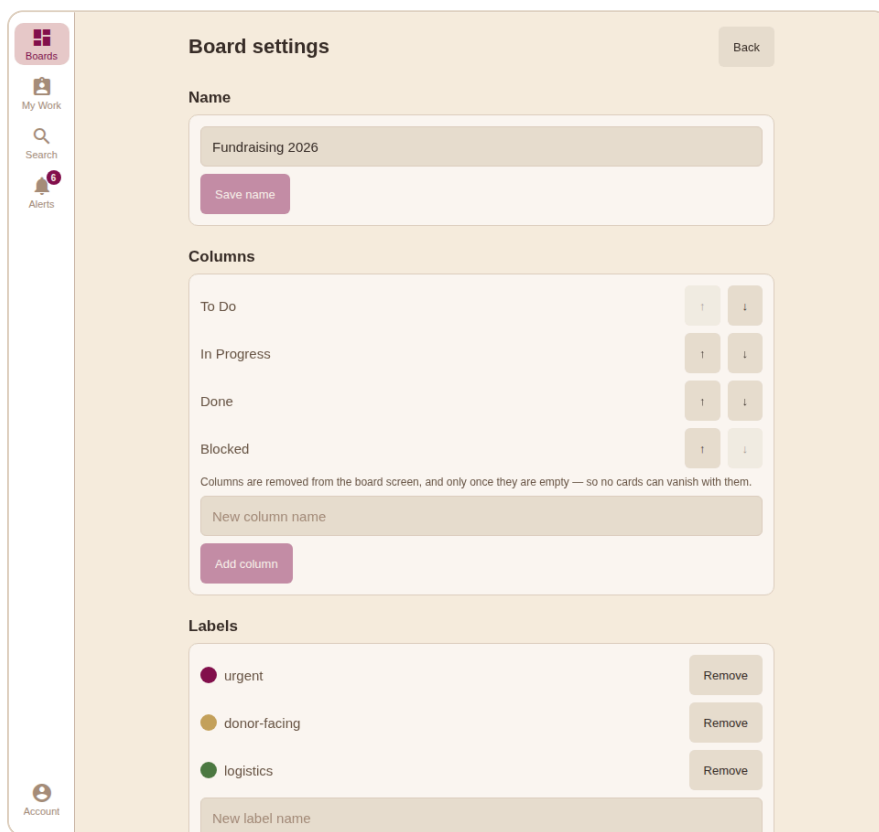
## Part 2 — For managers

Managers can see and join **every** board, create new ones, and shape a board's columns, labels, and membership. There are no per-board roles — a manager can act on any board.

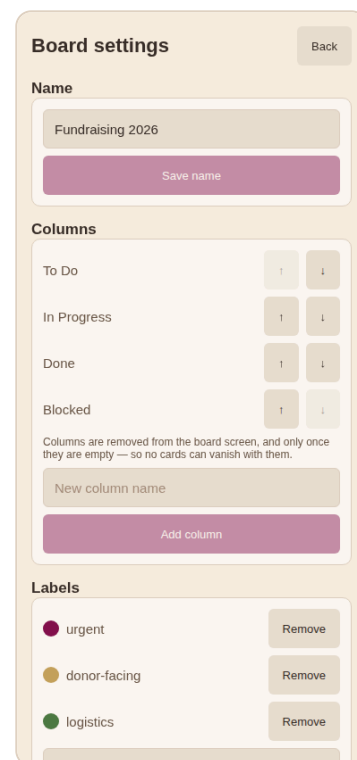
### 2.1 Creating a board

On **Boards**, tap **New board** and give it a name. Every new board starts with three columns — **To Do**, **In Progress**, **Done** — which you can rename or replace in Settings.

### 2.2 Board settings



*In a browser*



*On a phone*

Open a board and tap its **settings** (the gear). From here:

- **Columns** — add, rename, and reorder. Tap the **pencil** beside a column's name to rename it; drag the handle to reorder. A column can only be deleted once it's **empty**, so no cards vanish with it, and deleting one **asks first** because it cannot be undone. To clear a column quickly, select its cards and move or archive them in one go.

- **Labels** — a short, shared vocabulary for the board. Colours come from a fixed palette so they stay readable on the app's warm surfaces.
- **Members** — who can see the board. Removing someone also **unassigns them from that board's cards**; you're told how many before it happens. Your **own** row shows **Leave** instead of Remove — use it to step off a board you no longer work.
- **Archive** — hides the board from everyone's list. Boards are never deleted outright.

**Renaming a column without opening Settings.** Column names are editable from the board itself too — tap the **pencil** beside the column name (on a phone, in the column header at the top; on a wide screen, at the top of each column). Only managers and admins see it; everyone else just sees the name.

**Joining or leaving a board yourself.** Because managers and admins can open **any** board's settings, a board you haven't joined shows a **Join this board** button at the top of **Members**. Joining makes you assignable to its cards and lists the board under your own boards; **Leave** reverses both. Only your *own* membership is self-service — everyone else is added and removed by a manager or admin.

## 2.3 Archiving a board

Boards **archive**, they don't get hard-deleted, so nothing is lost by accident. Managers and admins see an **Archived** section at the bottom of the board list — open one from there and use **Restore** in its settings to bring it back. It stays collapsed unless something is actually archived.

## 2.4 Deleting cards

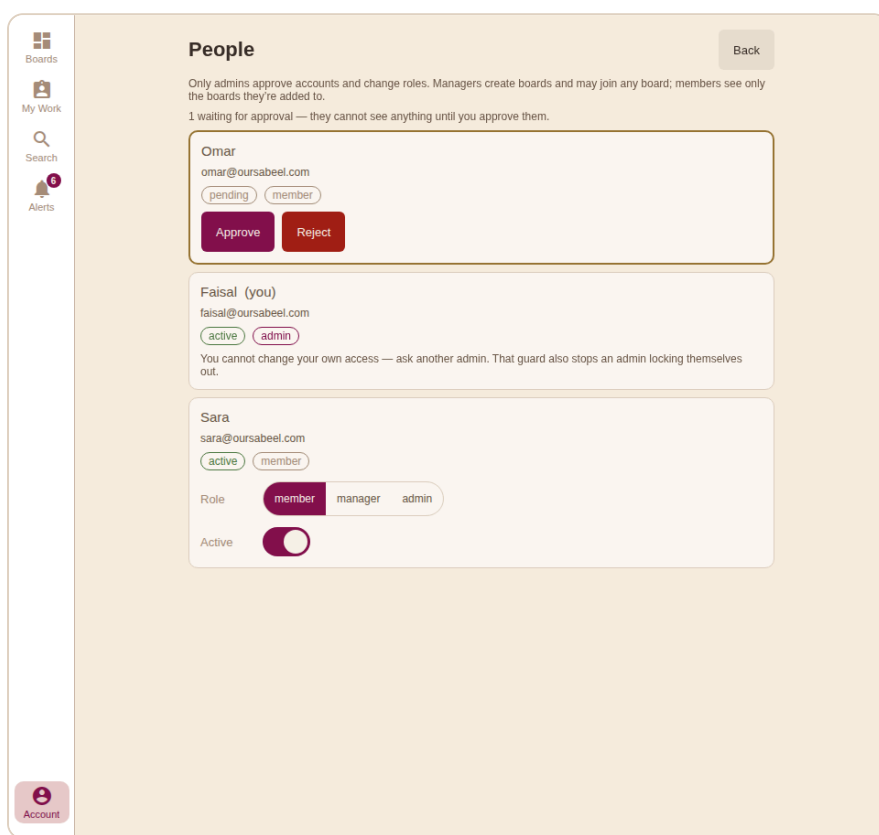
**Members archive** cards; **managers and admins can delete** them permanently. Archiving keeps a card out of the way but recoverable; deletion is final and takes its comments and history with it. When in doubt, archive.

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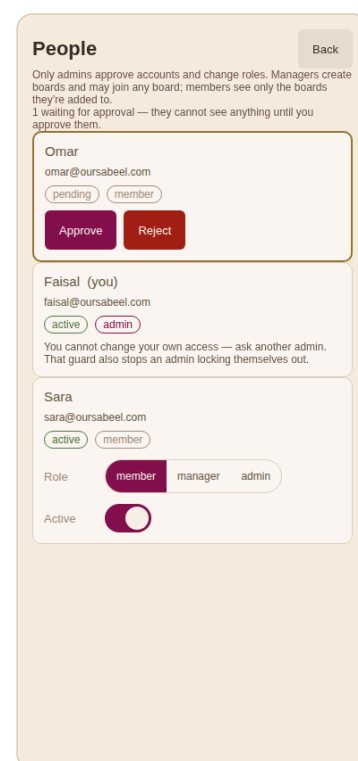
## Part 3 — For admins

Admins manage **people**. Everything a manager can do, an admin can do too — plus approve accounts and change roles.

### 3.1 The People screen — approving new users



*In a browser*



*On a phone*

Open **Account** → **People**. It lists everyone who has signed in. A new account waits on **pending** and sees nothing until you approve it — approve it here and their screen unlocks live, wherever they are. Admins also get a push notification when someone is waiting.

### 3.2 Managing a user

Each person's role and access are shown as **controls set to their current value** — a **role** (member / manager / admin) and an **Active** toggle — rather than buttons you press. You change someone by moving the control to where you want it:

- **Member** — sees only the boards they've been added to.

- **Manager** — can see and join every board, create boards, edit columns/labels/ membership, and delete cards.
- **Admin** — everything a manager can, plus approve accounts and change roles.
- **Active** — turn off to **disable** an account: they're signed out immediately and locked out, but **their card assignments are kept** so nothing is left ownerless — a manager can reassign at leisure. Turn back on to restore. Nothing is ever deleted.

Every change asks you to **confirm**, spelling out what it will actually let that person do, so a stray tap can't promote or lock out anyone. You **cannot change your own access** — that's what stops an admin locking themselves out.

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## Part 4 — “How do I...?” quick answers

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**...get in for the first time?** Sign in with your @oursabeel.com Google account, then wait on the approval screen until an admin lets you in (it updates by itself).

**...add a card?** Open the board → + **Add card** at the foot of a column → type a title → Enter.

**...change a card's priority, due date, or assignees?** Open the card → tap a priority / due date / **Assign someone** → choose.

**...move a card to another column?** In a browser, drag it. On a phone, long-press it and pick the column — or open the card and change the **column** dropdown.

**...move or copy cards to a different board?** Select them (tick boxes, or long-press on a phone) → **move/copy to another board** → pick the board and column.

**...find a card I can't see?** **Search** (its words), or **My Work** if it's assigned to you.

**...share a card with a colleague?** Open the card → **Share** → send the link. They open it and land on the card (if they're a member of its board).

**...see everything assigned to me?** **My Work** — grouped overdue → today → next seven days.

**...stop a noisy notification?** **Alerts** → **Settings** → switch off that kind, or **mute** the board.

**...create a board?** (*managers*) **Boards** → **New board** → name it.

**...rename or add columns / labels?** (*managers*) Open the board → **settings** → Columns or Labels.

**...add someone to a board?** (*managers*) Board **settings** → **Members** → add them. (They must be an approved account first.)

**...delete a card?** (*managers/admins*) Open the card → delete. Members **archive** instead.

**...let a new team member in?** (*admins*) They sign in once with Google → **Account** → **People** → **Approve** their pending card.

**...make someone a manager or admin?** (*admins*) **People** → their card → set the **role** → confirm the dialog.



...disable someone who left? (admins) **People** → their card → **Active** off → confirm. Their assignments and history stay.

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## Troubleshooting

| What you see                                  | What it means                                                | What to do                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| “Waiting for approval” after signing in       | Your account awaits admin approval                           | Ask your admin; the screen unlocks by itself once approved                            |
| You can’t sign in at all                      | Only @oursabeel.com Google accounts are allowed              | Use your work account, not a personal one                                             |
| A card’s due date is red                      | The card is overdue                                          | Open it and update the date, or get the work done                                     |
| “This card is unavailable” from a shared link | You’re not a member of its board, or the card was deleted    | Ask a manager to add you to the board                                                 |
| A column won’t delete                         | It still has cards in it                                     | Move or archive its cards first, then delete the column                               |
| Removing a board member warns about cards     | They’re assigned to cards on that board                      | Those cards are unassigned automatically; the warning just says how many              |
| No push notifications arriving                | Permission not granted on this device, or that kind is muted | Allow notifications when the app asks, and check <b>Alerts</b> → <b>Settings</b>      |
| A red “Live data error” bar                   | The app couldn’t reach the server or was refused             | It clears when the connection recovers; if it persists, tell Faisal what the bar says |

Manual source: `docs/USER-MANUAL.md` (images in `docs/manual/img/`, screenshots of the web app at desktop and phone widths). PDF: `docs/USER-MANUAL.pdf`, built with `docs/render-manual.py`. Update all three together when the app changes.